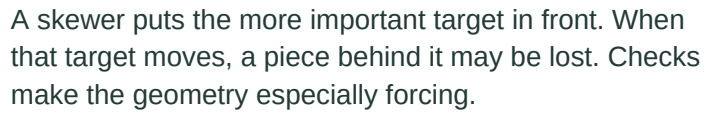


Skewers

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Search ranks, files, and diagonals where two enemy pieces line up. Calculate the first target's legal responses.

The defending king is on f2. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.

Previous move: 23.Nc4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

23...Rg2+ 24. Ke3 Re8+ 25. Kxd3 Rxe1

23...Rg2+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **24.Ke3.**

24...Re8+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **25.Kxd3**.

25...Rxe1 The rook captures the rook on e1.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

Using $P=1$, $N/B=3$, $R=5$, $Q=9$, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +4: the balance goes from -2 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

The defender may block, capture the attacker, or protect the rear piece while moving the front one. Alignment alone is not enough.